

EARNED,
NOT GRANTED.

We don't teach AI. We make engineers who ship.

An AI-native product engineering apprenticeship for India.

Traditional curriculum cannot keep pace with AI-native engineering workflows.

WHERE CURRICULUM ENDS

- Theoretical foundations are strong
- Limited time for shipping practice
- Production deployment rarely taught
- AI tooling changes every quarter
- AI debugging is a different discipline
- Startup workflows are hard to simulate

WHAT STARTUPS NEED

- AI-assisted development fluency
- Shipping velocity over algorithm depth
- Product and architecture judgment
- Evaluation discipline for AI features
- Async collaboration habits
- Debugging AI behaviour, not just code

Five reasons tier-2 colleges sign on.

Stagnant placements. Tier-1 student exits. NAAC pressure. No internal AI capacity. Admissions on autopilot.

- | | | |
|----|----------------------------|---|
| 01 | Placement statistics | Stagnant or declining numbers, with student exits to tier-1 alternatives. |
| 02 | Industry partnerships | AICTE and NAAC rankings increasingly weight industry tie-ups. |
| 03 | AI branding gap | “AI” is now table stakes, but no credible AI programme to point to. |
| 04 | Faculty bandwidth | No internal capacity to build or run an AI-native curriculum. |
| 05 | Admissions differentiation | Private colleges compete on marketing in every admission cycle. |

We have run this playbook before.

Build sprints and apprenticeship-style programmes already delivered with students at:

[PHOTO]
cohort / demo day

IIT Bombay
Build sprint cohort · [year]

[PHOTO]
cohort / demo day

IIT Gandhinagar
Build sprint cohort · [year]

[PHOTO]
cohort / demo day

IIT Madras
Build sprint cohort · [year]

[PHOTO]
cohort / demo day

IISc Bangalore
Build sprint cohort · [year]

Now bringing the same programme to forward-looking tier-2 engineering colleges.

What building actually looks like.

Students shipping — not sitting through slides.

[PHOTO]

demo day — students presenting shipped products

[PHOTO]

pair-building with Cursor

[PHOTO]

mentor code review

[PHOTO]

whiteboard architecture session

Every photo from a cohort
we have run. No stock
photos.

A 13-week apprenticeship. Not a course.

Built for engineering students. Integrated with tier-2 engineering colleges.
Designed around shipping, not sitting through slides.

COHORT 01

Earned,
not granted.

13

WEEKS

Aligned to semester windows

100

STUDENTS PER COHORT

In pods of 8–12, one mentor each

0

LECTURES

Students ship from week one

A week inside BuildAI looks like a week inside an AI startup.

MON	Sprint Kickoff	Week plan posted async. Students commit work in Linear.
TUE — THU	Build Days	AI-assisted implementation. PRs opened. Peer code reviews.
FRI	Demo Day	Async video demo from every student. Public archive.
SAT	Live Mentor Session	90-min architecture review, debugging, Q&A.
SUN	Peer Review	Cross-pod portfolio reviews. Reading group reflections.

A Wednesday in Week 6 of a BuildAI cohort.

Not a class schedule. The rhythm of a working AI startup, built into every cohort day.

09:00 AM

Review PR comments

Mentor left feedback overnight. Student replies, pushes a fix, requests re-review.

10:30 AM

Open GitHub issue

Linear ticket for a new feature. A 3-sentence design note before touching code.

12:00 PM

Build with Cursor

AI-assisted implementation. Half the code is generated; the student reviews every line.

03:00 PM

Debugging session

Hallucinated API response in production. Trace logs, write a regression eval, ship the fix.

05:00 PM

Review a peer's PR

Cross-pod review. Four substantive comments on another student's submission.

07:00 PM

Record demo video

3-minute walkthrough of what shipped today. Posted to the public Demo Day archive.

Six modules, organised around capabilities startups hire for.

M0

WEEK 1

AI-Native OS

Cursor, Claude Code, context engineering. Ship one app by end of week 1.

M1

WEEKS 2–4

Product Engineering

Next.js, Postgres, auth, deploys. Two live apps with real users.

M2

WEEKS 5–7

AI Product Patterns

LLM APIs, RAG, agents. One real AI-powered product.

M3

WEEK 8

Eval & Reliability

Eval-driven development. A suite that catches regressions.

M4

WEEKS 9–10

Shipping in a Startup

Teams of 3–4. Linear, PRs, sprint rituals, code review.

M5

WEEKS 11–13

Capstone

Public launch, real users — reviewed by an external AI-startup engineer.

Mentored by working engineers. Not by teaching assistants.

1 : 8–12

Mentor-to-student ratio

One lead mentor per pod. Every student's code gets senior eyes weekly.

4–6 hrs

Mentor hours per pod, per week

Async PR reviews through the week plus the live Saturday session.

100%

Of mentors actively shipping

Every mentor writes production code at an AI-first company today.

THE BENCH

Recruited from engineers at AI-first startups and product companies — top AI labs, fintech leaders, and YC-backed AI startups.

Mentors review code, run architecture sessions, and grade the rubric — the same engineers who later interview your students.

Seven dimensions. Two reviewers. External industry validation.

01	Shipping velocity	SCORED 1-5
02	Engineering judgment	SCORED 1-5
03	Product thinking	SCORED 1-5
04	AI fluency	SCORED 1-5
05	Collaboration	SCORED 1-5
06	Debugging	SCORED 1-5
07	Communication	SCORED 1-5

EXTERNAL VALIDATION

At Week 13, working engineers from real AI-first startups review top portfolios independently.

Their feedback enters the final score — and they become the hiring pipeline.

Three tiers. Earned, not granted.

Only ~30% of every cohort earns Apprentice Certified or above. Scarcity is what creates startup trust.

~70%

PARTICIPATED

Finished the programme, completed all assignments.

~20%

APPRENTICE CERTIFIED

All 7 rubric dimensions scored 3 or higher.

~10%

DISTINCTION

Top performers, externally validated, fast-tracked to startup placement.

No job guarantee — by design. The certificate keeps its value because it cannot be bought.

What every Apprentice Certified graduate walks away with.

5+

Deployed products in a public portfolio

3+

Live URLs with working demos

1

Capstone reviewed by an AI-startup engineer

13

Weeks of PR-reviewed, production-grade code

8+

Recorded architecture walkthroughs

1

Eval suite demonstrating reliability practice

What your institution gets when you partner with BuildAI.

01

Credible AI programme

An AI-native offering your admissions team can point to immediately.

02

Industry partnership

Documented industry tie-up for NAAC, AICTE, and placement reports.

03

Student outcomes

Measurable GitHub portfolios. Real deployed products. Marketing assets you own.

04

Administrative margin

₹5,000–₹7,000 per enrolled student. Yours to keep.

05

Zero faculty burden

BuildAI runs the entire programme. Your faculty focuses on core curriculum.

06

Hiring network access

Top graduates introduced to BuildAI's startup review network — a long-term pipeline.

Simple economics.

The college keeps an administrative margin.

STUDENT FEE

₹20K – ₹25K

What students pay for the 13-week apprenticeship.

COLLEGE MARGIN

₹5K – ₹7K

Per enrolled student. Administrative + facilitation margin.

BUILD AI FEE

₹15K – ₹18K

Per enrolled student. Covers mentors, tools, ops, evaluation.

Per-cohort margin to your institution (100 students × ₹6,000) = **₹6 lakh**

Two cohorts per year (summer + winter) = **₹12 lakh annual margin**

Start with a weekend. Graduate to the apprenticeship.

01

Weekend Sprint

1 weekend · ~15 hours

- One deployed app per student
- 1 lead mentor per pod of 8–12
- Tier-graded Sprint Certificate
- Min 20 students to run

₹3K – ₹5K / student

02

2-Weekend Sprint

~12 days · ~30 hours

- Two deployed apps per student
- One with a live LLM API call
- Prompt iteration + API safety
- Same certification rubric

₹8K – ₹9K / student

03

13-Week Apprenticeship

Full programme · 15–20 hrs/week

- 5+ products in a public portfolio
- External startup-engineer review
- Three-tier certification
- Distinction → placement pipeline

₹20K – ₹25K / student

Most partnerships start with a sprint. Sprint Distinction students seed the first apprenticeship cohort.

Why BuildAI is not Newton School, upGrad, or Internshala.

	BuildAI	Newton School	upGrad	Internshala
Format	Apprenticeship	Embedded school	Video courses	Self-paced
AI-native?	Built-in	Bolted on	Generic literacy	Basic prompts
Evaluation	7-dim + external review	Internal grading	Course completion	Auto certificate
Output	Public portfolio	Class projects	Certificate	Certificate
Pass rate	~70% (gated)	90%+	95%+	95%+
Price	₹20–25K	₹3–5L	₹15–40K	₹2–5K

AI is reshaping how software is built. India can either supply this workforce — or be supplied by it.

WHAT I'VE SEEN

Working at an AI-native company in the US, I see what AI-first startups actually hire for. The gap between that profile and what Indian colleges produce is structural, not cosmetic — and closeable in 13 weeks if the apprenticeship is rigorous.

WHY ME

IIT Bombay gave me the engineering foundation. Cornell Johnson sharpened the operating lens. Founding an AI-native company taught me what shipping actually feels like. The combination is what's needed to build a credible apprenticeship.

WHY NOW

AI-assisted engineering is no longer a 5-year horizon. It is the workflow. The colleges that integrate it over the next 18 months will define their placement decade. The ones that wait will spend five years catching up.

Built by a founder who has lived this gap.



Sharad Agrawal

FOUNDER, BUILD AI

IIT Bombay Masters, 2018

Cornell Johnson MBA, 2024

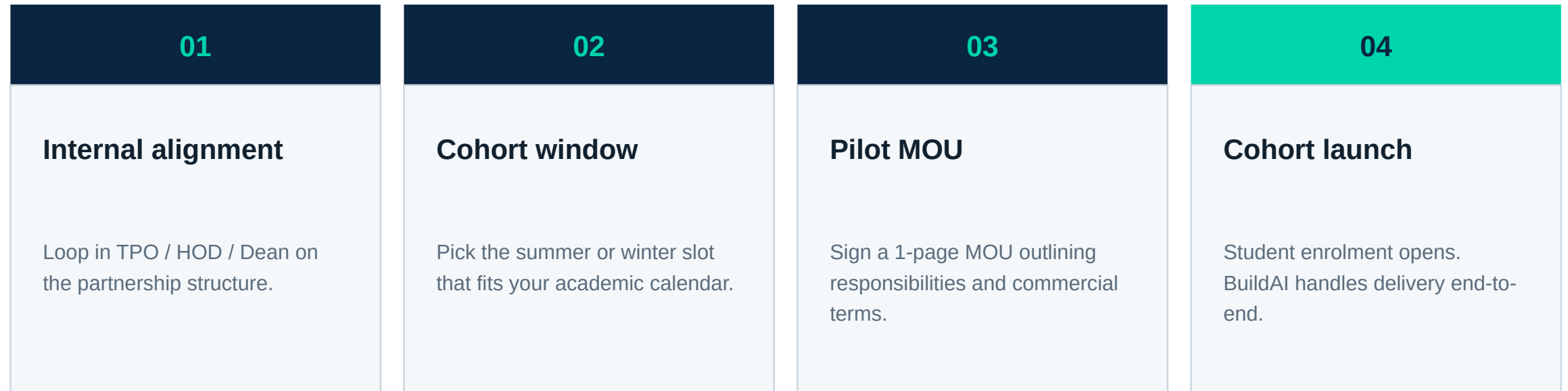
Currently Founder of an AI-native company in the US

Based in US · India ops led by co-founder (recruitment in progress)

“The single most important hire of the next 18 months is the India co-founder.”

— SHARAD AGRAWAL, FOUNDER

The pilot partnership process.



A 30-student pilot is enough to produce public proof. No long-term commitment required to start.

Let's run a pilot together.

Even a 30-student first cohort produces public proof your institution can show.

SHARAD AGRAWAL

Founder, BuildAI

[contact email — TBD]

IIT Bombay '18 · Cornell MBA '24